[METRIC]
A-A-2893A
October 03,1997
SUPERSEDES
A-A-2893
November 15,1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PAD, WRITING, LEATHERETTE BINDING OR LINEN BINDING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description for all Federal Agencies.

1. **SCOPE**: This description covers three sizes of writing pads that are made with an artificial leatherette binding or linen binding.

2. **CLASSIFICATION**: Writing Pads covered by this commercial item description shall be of the following two types and styles.

Type I - Leatherette Binding
Type II - Linen Binding

3. **SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS**:

3.1 Material: The paper shall be white and made from at least 95 percent bleached chemical pulp.

3.2 Physical Requirement Of Paper:

Table I

Characteristic	Requirement	TAPPI Test Method
Basis Weight avg.g/m^2 (lbs,17x22-500) ± 5%	60 (16)	T410
Bursting strength , Kpa avg., min.(psi)	83 (12)	T403
Thickness,mm,±0.012 mm (inch, ± 0.0005 inch)	0.07 (0.0030)	T411
Opacity, percent, min	75	T425

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. Any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza New York, N.Y. 10278.

FSC 7530

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3.21 Color: The Leatherette Binding or Linen Binding shall be specified in the Ordering Data, the color of the paper shall be white, and all sheets in a pad shall be the same color.

3.3 Writing quality: Paper of Type I and Type II pads shall be sufficiently sized to accept fountain pen ink writing without feathering or ink penetration through to the opposite side of the sheet when tested as follows. Draw several lines and characters on both surfaces of the paper with a medium point (commercial type) fountain pen using a one (1) percent aqueous solution of Acid Red 1 Color Index Number 18050 or Acid Green 3 Color Index Number 42085. The lines and the characters shall be clear out and shall not feather or penetrate through to the opposite side of the paper. Both surfaces of the pad paper shall be sized or processed to provide good erasability. Good erasability of the paper surface shall be determined as follows. Draw several lines and characters with a No. 21/2 lead pencil and erase with a latex rubber eraser; on the same area, redraw pencil lines or characters and erase. The tested area shall not show smearing of the pencil lines, or failure of the paper fiber.

3.4 Backing: The pad backing shall be chipboard or other suitable paperboard that conform to Table II.

Table II

Characteristic	Requirement	TAPPI Test Method
Thickness, min., mm (inch)	1.2(0.050) for type I 0.66(0.026) for type II	T411
Bursting strength, avg.min. kpa(psi)	413(60) for type I 413(60) for type II	T403

3.5 Size: The pads shall be 12.7 x 20.3 cm (5x8 inch), 21.6 x 29.8 cm (8 1/2 x 11 3/4 inch), or 21.6 x 35.6 cm (8 1/2 x 14 inch) as specified in the ordering data. A tolerance of ± 0.3 cm (± 1/8 inch) in each direction shall be permitted. The first dimension given is the horizontal dimension.

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3.6 Rulings: The sheets shall be ruled on both sides and conform to the following spacings:
Lines shall be spaced 0.8 cm (5/16 inch) apart with a tolerance of ± 0.1 cm (± 1/16 inch). The first line shall begin not less than 2.7 cm (1 1/16 inch) nor more than 3.6 cm (1 7/16 inch) from the perforation on the front side and from the bottom of the back side of the paper. The unlined portion of the front side of the sheet shall be located at the binding end of the sheet, and the unlined portion of the back side of the sheet shall be located at the end opposite the binding end.

There shall be 2 vertical rulings extending the full length of the sheet. For size 12.7 x 20.3 cm (5x8 inch) pad, the two vertical rulings shall be located 2.5 ± 0.3 cm (1 inch, ± 1/8 inch) from the left edge of the sheet. For other sizes, the rulings shall be located 3.2 cm, +0.4, or -0.3 cm (1 1/4 inch, +3/16, or -1/8 inch) from the left edge of the paper. The width between 2 vertical rulings shall not exceed 0.3 cm (1/8 inch).

3.7 Ink: The ruling ink shall be blue, except that the vertical ruling shall be red. The ruling shall be continuous and uniform without waviness or feathering of the lines.

3.8 Assembly of pads: Each pad shall contain no less than 50 sheets. The sheets shall have a backing sheet of equal size, ± 0.1 cm (± 1/16 inch) and a front reinforcing strip of the same material. The front reinforcing strip shall run the full width of the pad and shall extend 1.9 cm, ± 0.1cm (3/4 inch, ± 1/16 inch) from the top edge of the pad. A minimum of two staples shall fasten together the front reinforcing strip, sheets and sheets and backing sheet. "For Type I pad" a brown, leatherette (artificial leather) binding strip of non-woven coated paper, stamped in gold colored foil with the word "SKILCRAFT" and a recycled logo, shall be firmly adhered to the backing, top edge and reinforcing strip. "For Type II Pad," a linen binding strip need not have the word "SKILCRAFT" logo embossed on the top or need not have the recycled logo. The binding strip shall cover the front reinforcing strip, plus 0.8 mm (1/32 inch), minus 0.1 cm (1/16 inch) and shall extend and cover the full width of the backing sheet for a distance of not less than 1.3 cm (1/2 inch) from the top edge. The binding strip shall be attached with a suitable adhesive. The sheets shall be perforated across the width of the pad. The perforations shall be parallel to the bottom edge of the reinforcing strip and shall not fall under the strip nor be located beyond the bottom edge of the strip by more than 0.1 cm (1/16 inch).

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3.9 Padding strength: Hold the pad to be tested in a stationary, vertical position with the padded edge down. While holding the backing, allow the sheet pad to naturally fall until it hangs supported by the padding, without twisting or jerking the backing. Repeat the test three additional times to ensure that the pads of sheets shall not become detached from the pad backing nor separated for more than one inch along the padded edge.

3.10 Workmanship: The paper and pad shall be free from any defects that may affect appearance or serviceability.

4.0 REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS:

4.1 Certification: The contractor shall certify that the regulatory requirements for recovered materials shall be as specified in the Ordering Data and applicable solicitation. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.2 Bleaching: To obtain an acceptable brightness, in accordance with the performance standards of this document, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified in the ordering data, the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or other chlorine compounds. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.3 Labeling: The recycled content shall be marked on the product or unit pack.

5.0 QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS:

5.1 Product Conformance: The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Testing: Testing shall be conducted in accordance with the referenced tests in the commercial Item Description. (Note: See TAPPI T400 for specific sampling instructions and acceptance criteria.)

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6.0 **PRESERVATION, PACKING AND MARKING:** Preservation, packing and marking shall be specified in the contract or order.

7.0 **APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS AND DOCUMENT SOURCES:** The following documents form a part of the Commercial Item Description to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:
1. Tappi Standards are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.

8.0 **ORDERING DATA:** Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

1. Type, style color and size required.
2. Basis weight of paper, bursting strength, thickness and opacity.
3. Non-chlorine bleaching is required.
4. Specific, packaging, packing and marking.
5. Whether bleaching without use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or hypochlorite is required.

9.0 **LIST OF NSN'S:**

7530-01-372-3107 7530-01-372-3108 7530-01-372-3109

MILITARY INTEREST:
NONE: DOD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
GSA-FSS

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